LIVEOPS & GAME DESIGN · HO CHI MINH CITY

Huynh Thanh Nghi

I run live operations on anime-IP mobile F2P games — own the calendar, build events around the characters players love, and back every call with player data. **3 anime-IP titles, 10M+ combined downloads, 5+ years of LiveOps.**

View shipped titles · Contact · LinkedIn

PLAYER PROFILE

Class: LiveOps Lead / Game Designer

LiveOps calendars & events	5+ yrs
Character-driven gacha / IAP	3 anime IPs
Retention & KPI analysis	D1 · D30
Vietnamese	Native
English	TOEIC 970

Shipped Titles 配信タイトル

How I ran each game live, what I decided from the data, and what happened next.
All free-to-play mobile titles shipped at enish, mainly for the Japanese market.

LAUNCHED 07/2026 · LIVE

Yowamushi Pedal: Resonance Pedaism

弱虫ペダル レゾナンス・ペダイズム — Training sim × bicycle road racing (anime IP)

ROLE	PERIOD	DOWNLOADS	TEAM
Lead Game Designer · PM	08/2025 – present	90K+ in first month	26 people · 7 disciplines + outsourcing

PHASE
Concept → launch → live ops

No.1 PAYING-USER RATIO AT ENISH

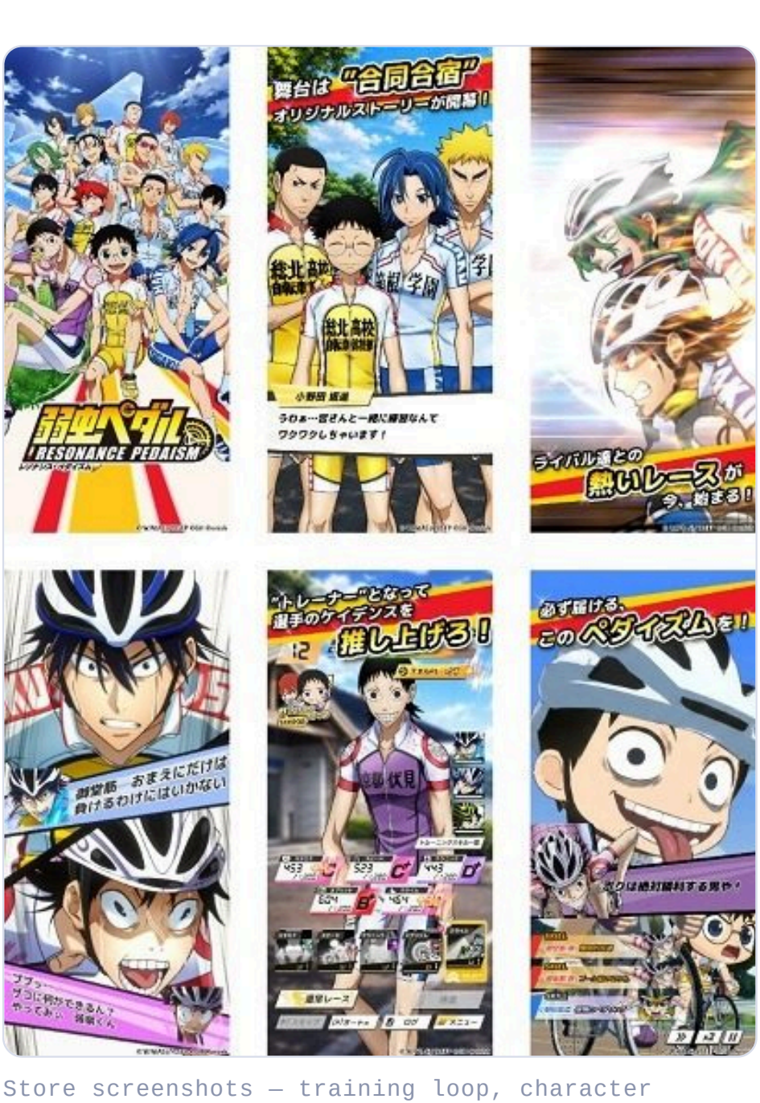
Quarterly OPERATION CALENDAR I RAN

44 → 73% D1 RETENTION AFTER REDESIGN

7 → 9–10% D30 AFTER LIVE REBALANCE

HOW I RAN LIVEOPS

- **Calendar:** planned a quarter ahead — story, ranking, login-bonus, birthday, anniversary and collab events, plus gacha and packs — and re-tuned it as daily KPI and player data came in. Plans were approved by the Japan office's Chief of Production.
- **Silver Week campaign:** I spotted the 5-day holiday coming and built a short campaign for it — a special PvE event, packs and login bonuses — so players had more to do while they were online more. **Purchases rose 150%** vs. the same period before.
- **Fixing a weak event:** a 1-day event with only login bonuses, missions and an exchange shop faded fast. I added a short 1-day ranking that pushed players to speed up their training — activity, spending and resource use all rose.
- **Oshi economy:** players are IP fans — mostly women who love the male cast — and spend most on their favorite character. I schedule banners around birthdays and holidays, put the most popular characters on the days I want to push hardest, and rotate character types. Result: the highest paying-user ratio of any enish title.
- **Retention intervention:** comparing players who churned around day 30 with those who stayed pointed to late-game RNG that made training and purchases feel meaningless. I rebalanced RNG to matter most in evenly matched races and ran win-back campaigns. **D30 rose from 7% to 9–10%.**
- **Store & cross-functional:** set pack lineups and prices, registered them on Google Play and the App Store, and set up partner webshops; planned SNS campaigns with marketing, briefed Customer Support before releases, and cleared IP-holder approvals.



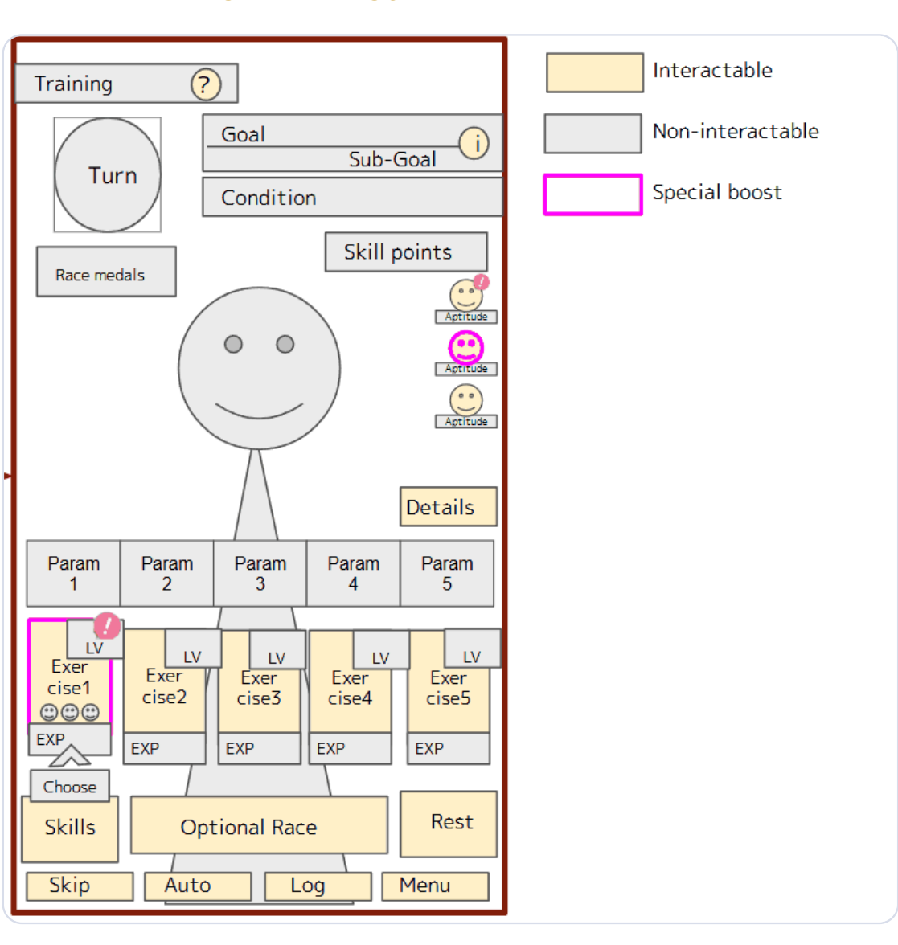
Store screenshots — training loop, character development, road race

▶ Watch the gameplay video

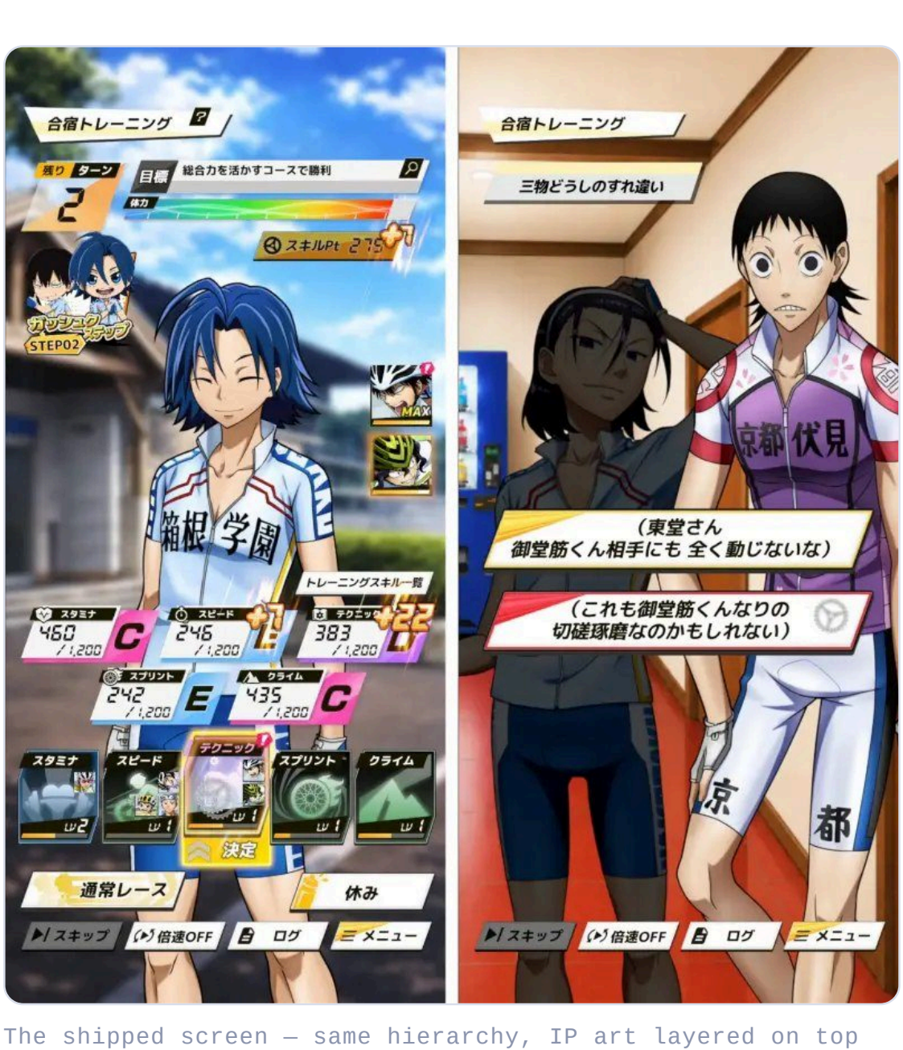
WHAT I DESIGNED

- Owned the two core features — training simulation and race — from benchmark research and GDD to shipped build; balanced IAP packs and gacha lineups.
- Between test plays, cut the training cycle by two-thirds so players reached the payoff faster — **D1 retention rose from 44% to 73%**.

WIREFRAME → SHIPPED SCREEN

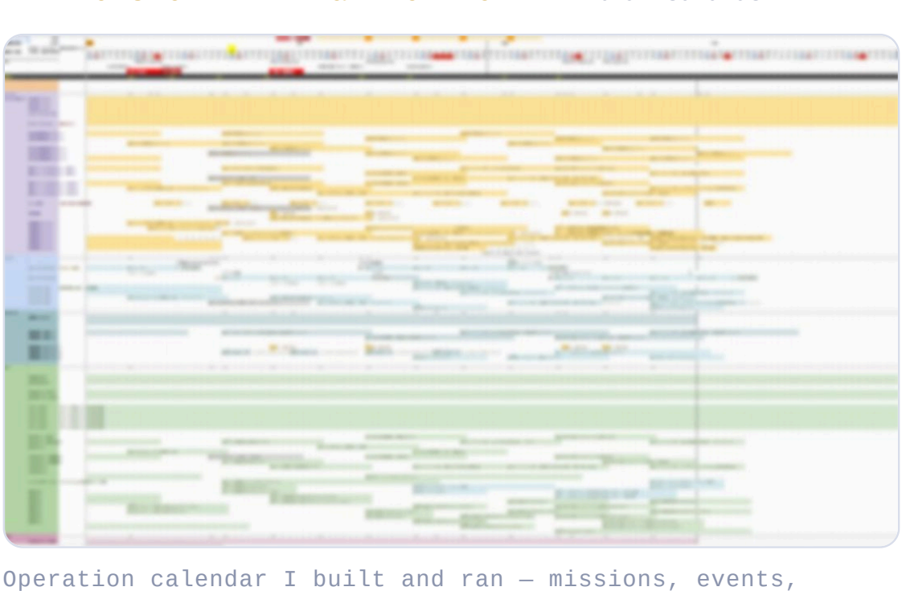


Wireframe I authored — interaction legend built into the spec

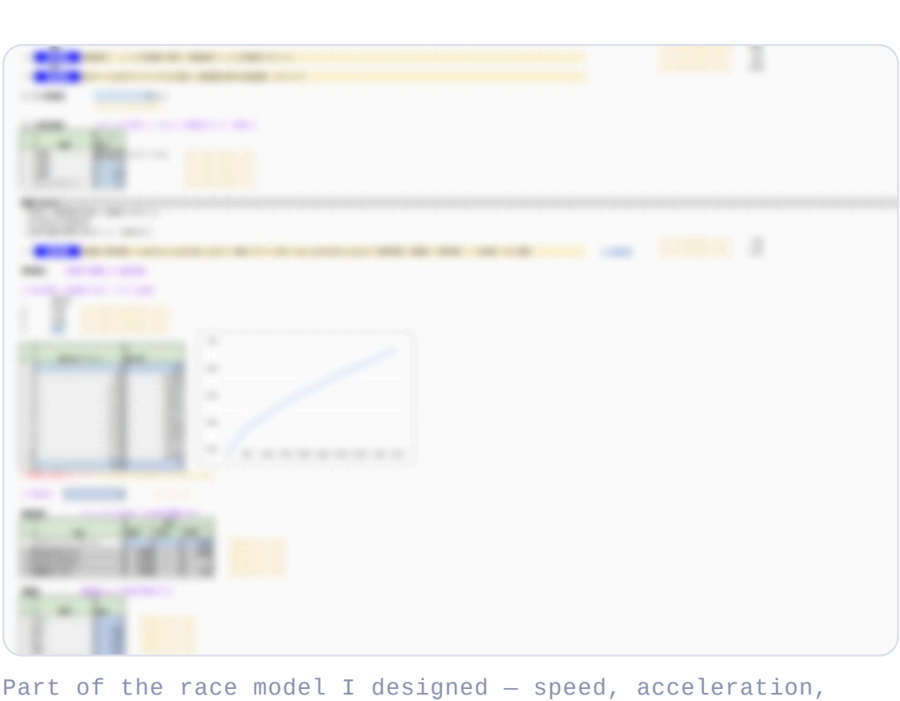


The shipped screen — same hierarchy, IP art layered on top

LIVE-OPS CALENDAR & RACE MODEL — blurred under NDA



Operation calendar I built and ran — missions, events, ranking and gacha across a quarter



Part of the race model I designed — speed, acceleration, gradient and wind corrections

RESULT

90K+ downloads in the first month, **4.0+ store rating**, and the **highest paying-user ratio of any title enish has shipped**. D1 retention 44% → 73% after the playtest redesign; D30 7% → 9–10% after the live rebalance. Further metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

09/2022 – 08/2025 · LIVE

De:Lithe Last Memories

ディライズ ラストメモリーズ — Roguelike action RPG (F2P / Web3)

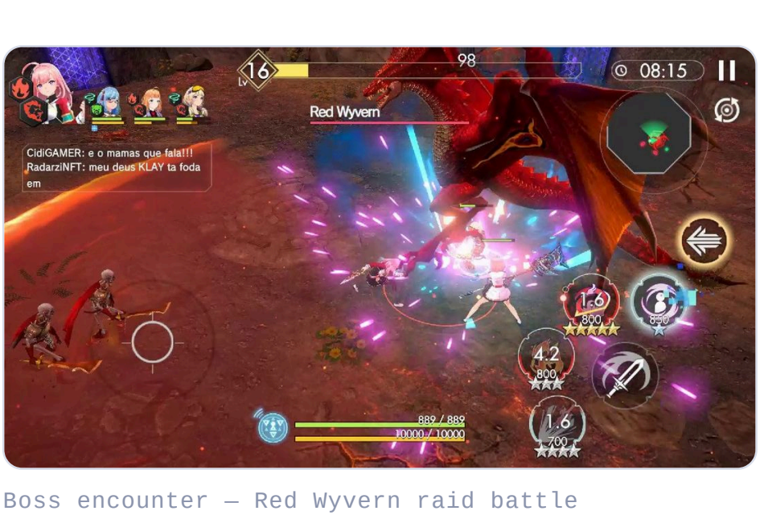
ROLE	PERIOD	DOWNLOADS	SCOPE
Game Designer — Battle team lead	3 years	800K+	PvP · GvG · skills · stages

WHAT I DESIGNED

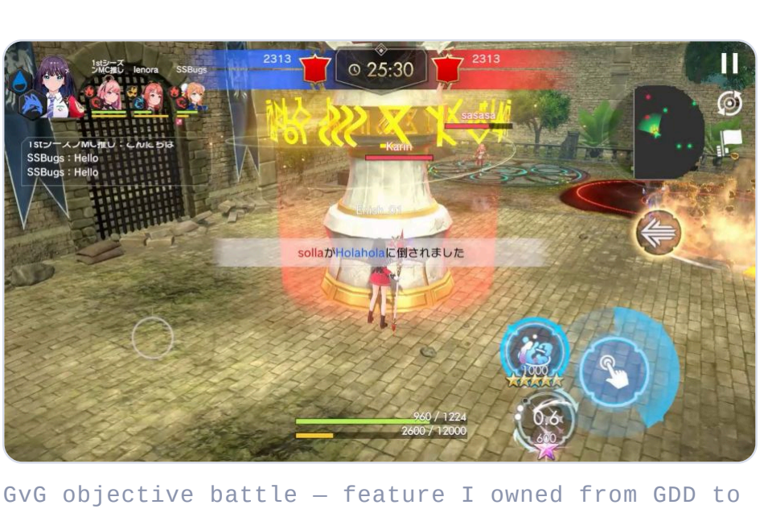
- Owned the competitive modes — ranked PvP and GvG — end-to-end: GDD, development, launch and post-launch tuning.
- Level design for monsters, bosses and stages; character skills from concept to numbers and balancing.
- Tuned battle feel with engineers in the in-house action-command system; directed BGM/SE/voice.
- Shipped every stage, boss and skill on schedule — placing and managing the art, sound and voice orders for each one.

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

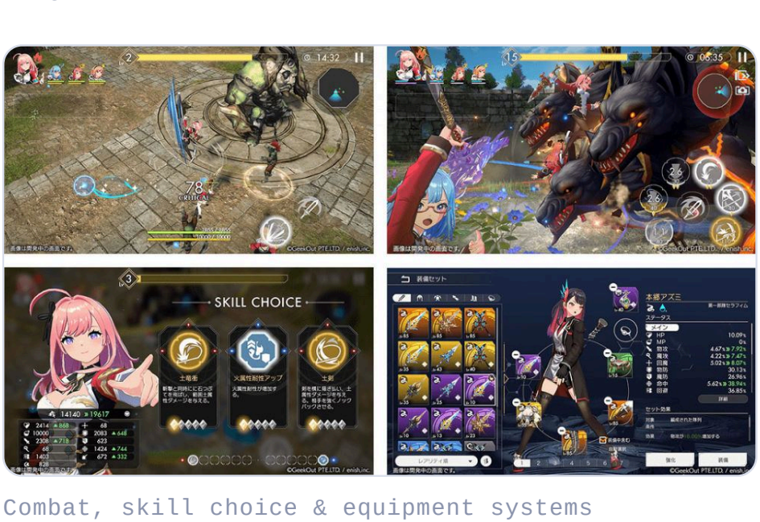
- PvP and GvG were mine from blank page to live season — ranked seasons running continuously since December 2024, each with its own arena and rules instead of reused PvE content.
- Designed 60+ stages, plus the monsters, bosses and skills that fill them — every one shipped on schedule.



Boss encounter — Red Wyvern raid battle

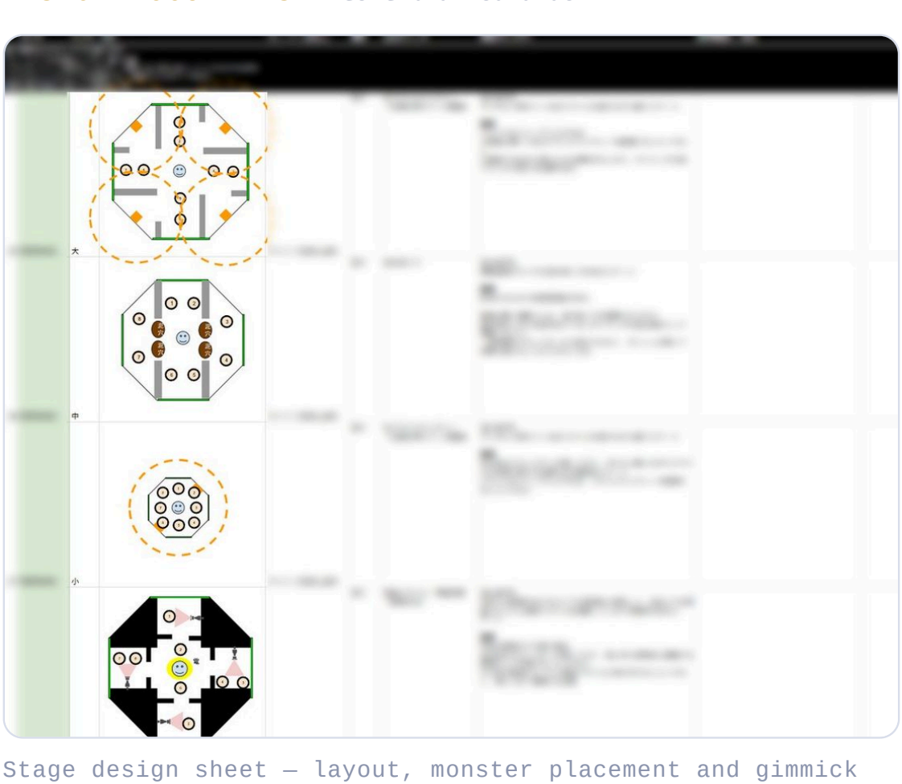


GvG objective battle — feature I owned from GDD to live

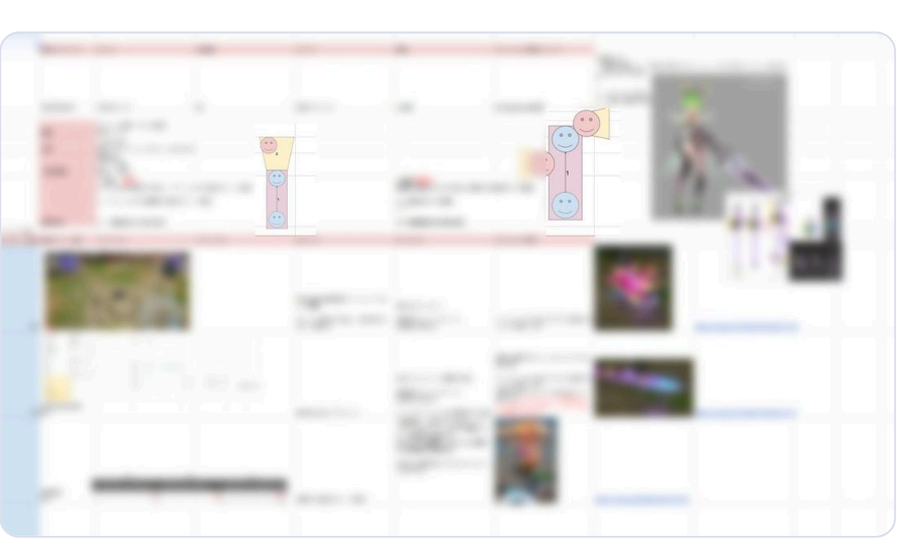


Combat, skill choice & equipment systems

DESIGN DOCUMENTS — text blurred under NDA



Stage design sheet — layout, monster placement and gimmick coverage, with the concept beside each stage



Skill sheet — attack range and motion sketched frame by frame, then specced for engineers and artists

RESULT

800K+ downloads since the June 2024 launch; the **PvP / GvG seasons I owned have run continuously since December 2024**. Detailed metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

02/2021 – 03/2022 · SERVICE ENDED

The Quintessential Quintuplets: Can't Divide the Puzzle Into Five

五等分の花嫁 五つ子ちゃんはパズルを五等分できない — Anime IP match puzzle

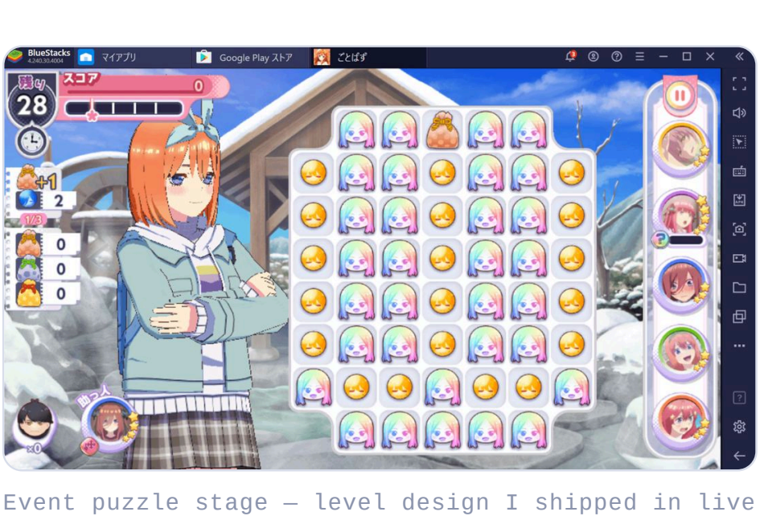
ROLE	DOWNLOADS	TEAM LED	SCOPE
Game Designer · Operator	9.2M	4 (VN office)	Events · gacha · level design

WHAT I DESIGNED

- Ran the live-ops pipeline — event puzzles, gacha, campaigns — leading the 4-person Vietnam team.
- Designed event puzzle levels and iterated on them with live KPI data (DAU, ARPPU).
- Shipped UI/UX improvements from reference to release; wrote official release notes in Japanese.

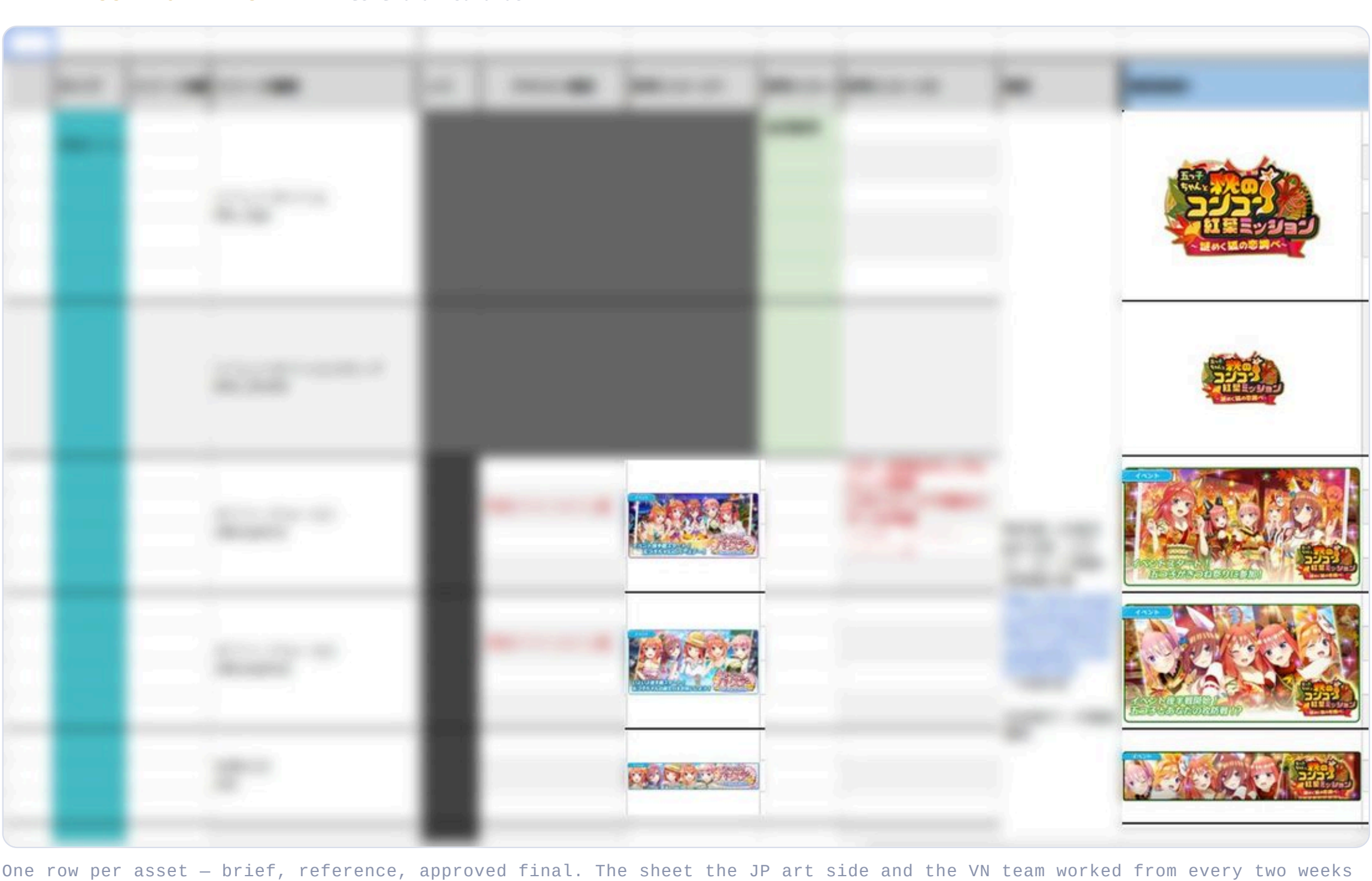
PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

- Held a fixed rhythm for 13 months with no missed release dates: an event every two weeks, a campaign with a new or improved feature every quarter.
- Standardised the pipeline — idea → puzzle set → master data → Japanese release note — and staggered it so two events were always in flight.
- Set difficulty from the previous event's data: clear speed, and how many players finished at all.
- The quarterly slot produced the “Cooking Raiha” idle-cooking system (feature video) — event materials got somewhere to go, so missing an event no longer meant nothing to come back for.



Event puzzle stage — level design I shipped in live ops

EVENT ASSET ORDER SHEET — text blurred under NDA



One row per asset — brief, reference, approved final. The sheet the JP art side and the VN team worked from every two weeks

RESULT

9.2M downloads. An event every two weeks and a quarterly feature update, held for 13 months by the 4-person team I led. Detailed metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

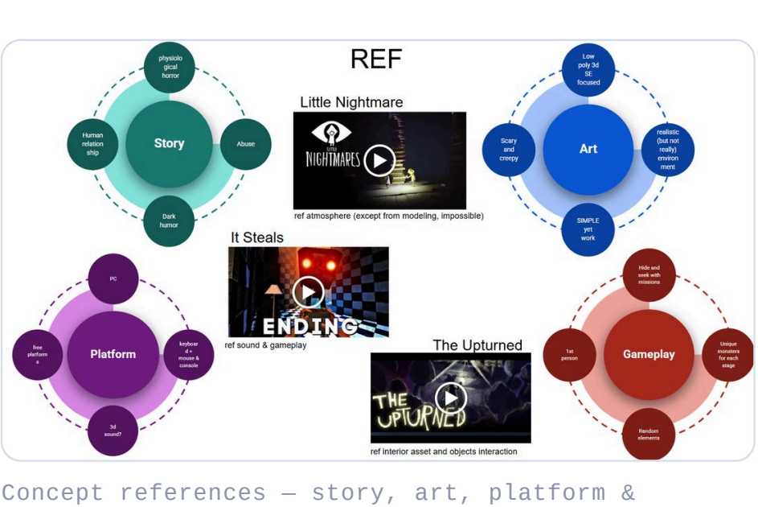
05/2025 – 09/2025 · PUBLISHED ON ITCH.IO

Latte Night — personal project

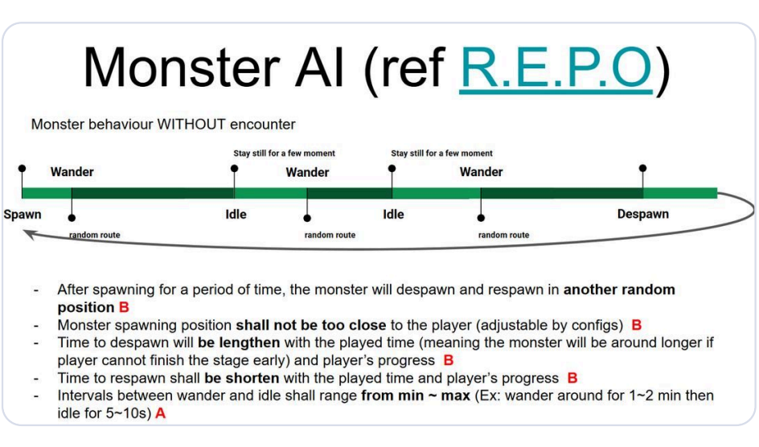
ROLE	LINK
Game Designer (team of 2)	hatching-chickens.itch.io/latte-night

- Defined core gameplay, art concept and story; designed the stage, monster behaviour, controls and lighting from prototype to published build.

In-game — light as the core survival resource



Concept references — story, art, platform & gameplay pillars



Monster AI (ref R.E.P.O)

Monster behaviour WITHOUT encounter

- After spawning for a period of time, the monster will despawn and respawn in **another random position** B
- Monster spawning position **shall not be too close** to the player (adjustable by configs) B
- Time to despawn will **be lengthen** with the played time (meaning the monster will be around longer if player cannot finish the stage early) and player's progress B
- Time to respawn shall **be shorten** with the played time and player's progress B
- Intervals between wander and idle shall range **from min ~ max** (Ex: wander around for 1~2 min then idle for 5~10s) A

Monster AI behavior design (wander / idle / despawn cycle)

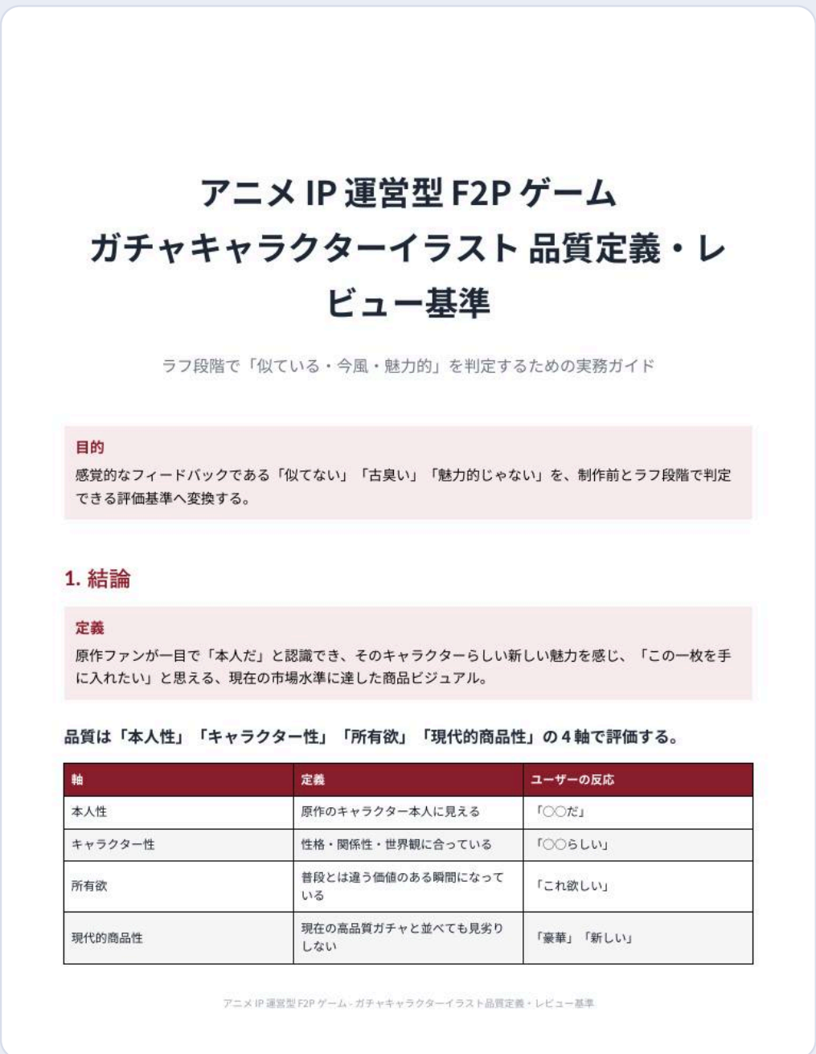
▶ Play Latte Night on itch.io

Quality & IP Management 品質管理

“Doesn't look like them.” “Old-fashioned.” “Not attractive.” — vague IP feedback stalls art for weeks. I wrote a review standard that turns it into criteria art and the IP holder can check at rough stage.

GACHA ILLUSTRATION QUALITY STANDARD

- **Four gates, not a score:** identity (it's really them), character (it's like them), ownership (“I want this one”), modern appeal (holds up next to today's top gacha). A card passes only when all four do.
- **Taste made checkable:** “similar” becomes face, silhouette, expression and posture; “modern” becomes camera, light and depth against a benchmark set refreshed each quarter.
- **“Attractive” made a spec:** each order carries one sentence defining the moment fans will want to own.
- Agreed through meetings with the IP holder — approvals stopped blocking releases. Written with AI assistance for structure and Japanese review.



アニメ IP 運営型 F2P ゲーム
ガチャキャラクターイラスト 品質定義・レビュー基準

ラフ段階で「似ている・今風・魅力的」を判定するための実務ガイド

目的
感覚的なフィードバックである「似てない」「古臭い」「魅力的じゃない」を、制作前とラフ段階で判定できる評価基準へ変換する。

1. 結論

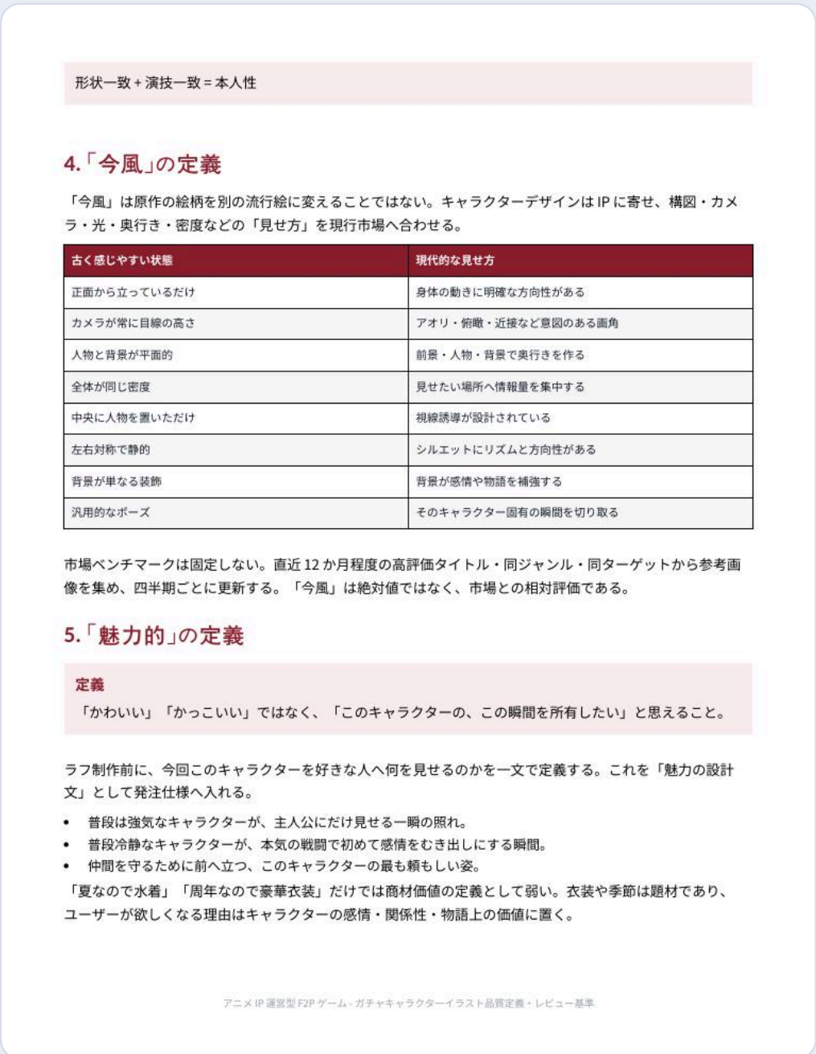
定義
原作ファンが一目で「本人だ」と認識でき、そのキャラクターらしい新しい魅力を感じ、「この一枚を手に入れたい」と思える、現在の市場水準に達した商品ビジュアル。

品質は「本人性」「キャラクター性」「所有欲」「現代的商品性」の4軸で評価する。

軸	定義	ユーザーの反応
本人性	原作のキャラクター本人に見える	「〇〇だ」
キャラクター性	性格・関係性・世界観に合っている	「〇〇らしい」
所有欲	普段とは違う価値のある瞬間になっている	「これ欲しい」
現代的商品性	現在の高品質ガチャと並べても見劣りしない	「豪華」「新しい」

アニメ IP 運営型 F2P ゲーム・ガチャキャラクターイラスト品質定義・レビュー基準

The standard (Japanese) — definition and four evaluation axes



形状一致＋演技一致＝本人性

4.「今風」の定義

「今風」は原作の絵柄を別の流行絵に変えることではない。キャラクターデザインは IP に寄せ、構図・カメラ・光・奥行き・密度などの「見せ方」を現行市場へ合わせる。

古く感じやすい状態	現代的な見せ方
正面から立っているだけ	身体の動きに明確な方向性がある
カメラが常に目線の高さ	アオリ・俯瞰・近接など意図のある画角
人物と背景が平面的	前景・人物・背景で奥行きを作る
全体が同じ密度	見せたい場所へ情報量を集中する
中央に人物を置いただけ	視線誘導が設計されている
左右対称で静的	シルエットにリズムと方向性がある
背景が単なる装飾	背景が感情や物語を補強する
汎用的なポーズ	そのキャラクター固有の瞬間を切り取る

市場ベンチマークは固定しない。直近 12 か月程度の高評価タイトル・同ジャンル・同ターゲットから参考画像を集め、四半期ごとに更新する。「今風」は絶対値ではなく、市場との相対評価である。

5.「魅力的」の定義

定義
「かわいい」「かっこいい」ではなく、「このキャラクターの、この瞬間を所有したい」と思えること。

ラフ制作前に、今回このキャラクターを好きな人へ何を見せるのかを一文で定義する。これを「魅力の設計文」として発注仕様へ入れる。

- 普段は強気なキャラクターが、主人公にだけ見せる一瞬の照れ。
- 普段冷静なキャラクターが、本気の戦闘で初めて感情をむき出しにする瞬間。
- 仲間を守るために前へ立つ、このキャラクターの最も頼もしい姿。

「夏なので水着」「周年なので豪華衣装」だけでは商材価値の定義として弱い。衣装や季節は題材であり、ユーザーが欲しくなる理由はキャラクターの感情・関係性・物語上の価値に置く。

アニメ IP 運営型 F2P ゲーム・ガチャキャラクターイラスト品質定義・レビュー基準

Old-fashioned vs. modern presentation — turning taste into a checklist

AI in My Workflow AI活用

I build AI agents for my team, because how fast a team iterates matters as much as what it ships.

Quality
A daily bug-check agent scans master data and code against the operation schedule. QA's routine check dropped to **under 10 minutes a day**, freeing them for functional and event testing.

Master data
An agent reads level-design docs — rates, rewards, quantities — and enters the data itself. We only review. Doc-to-data mismatches went to **zero**.

Docs & planning
Agents keep every GDD on one format so documents never contradict each other, and draft event schedules, reports and JP correspondence for my review.

How I Run a LiveOps Calendar 運営

The loop behind 5+ years of live operations on anime-IP titles.

1 · Plan a quarter, adjust daily
The calendar is set a quarter ahead, then re-tuned as KPIs move. Holidays are opportunities: a Silver Week campaign lifted purchases 150%.

2 · Propose with a recommendation
One recommended plan backed by detailed data, alternatives with pros and cons, and a clear reason for the pick — benchmarked against Umamusume and Blue Lock schedules.

3 · Characters first
Fans pay for their oshi. Banners follow birthdays and holidays, the most popular characters land on the biggest days, and character types rotate. Where the IP holder requires balance — all five Quintuplets sisters on every banner — the plan follows it.

4 · Review every event
Participation and completion, revenue vs. the last similar event, best-selling packs and price points, DAU, and CS / review / SNS feedback — prioritized and fixed in the very next event.

5 · Read the segments
Churned vs. retained players found the RNG problem behind a weak D30; spenders vs. non-spenders shape which packs and banners go where.

6 · Turn requests into features
Players asked for returning-player rewards. AI agents researched other games, listed options, checked what we already had and drafted specs — I reviewed and decided at every step.

About 自己紹介

I came to games from an unusual road — a Japanese Law degree, then language school in Japan. Law taught me to read dense material closely, find the rule underneath it, and argue from evidence rather than instinct — the same muscle behind benchmark research, GDD writing, and reading KPI data before touching a number.

Every genre I've shipped in — match puzzle, action RPG, training sim — I learned from zero. Breaking an unfamiliar domain down and turning it into a spec other people can build from is what I do fastest. Japanese, Vietnamese and English are how I gather that information, not the whole of what I bring.

Five years at enish took me from running events on a 9.2M-download anime-IP puzzle game to leading the design team of a new anime-IP title through launch and live ops.

I play widely, too — 348 hours in *Umamusume: Pretty Derby*, plus *Blue Lock: Project World Champion*, otome titles like *Idols of Starlight*, *Summoners War*, *Arena of Valor*, *Dark War Survival*, *Cult of the Lamb*, *Sea of Stars*, *Little Nightmares*, *God of War*, *The Last of Us* and *Horizon*.

Long-term goal: to ship a game the world knows as **made in Vietnam, led by a woman**.

Languages & Recognition

Vietnamese	Native
English	TOEIC 970 · IELTS 7.0
Japanese	JLPT N1 · J-Test 707
Best Employee of the Year, enish Vietnam	×3 consecutive
Japan Foundation young researchers program	2018

Let's make something players remember.

Open to LiveOps roles on character-driven ACGN titles.

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